

Moore, Russell and Early Wittgenstein — MCQ Questions

56-question closed-book bank · no answer key

Attempt closed-book and record option, reasoning and confidence in PRACTICE-LOG.md before opening MCQ-SOLUTIONS.md. The 56-question total closes the distinct-operation coverage matrix after an explicit audit of the 56-question g5 source: 2 retained stems, 35 adapted questions and 19 replacements for merged or removed candidates. No answer, hint, explanation or answer-pattern cue is intentionally present here.

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MCQ 1

The analytic revolt represented by Moore, Russell and the early Wittgenstein is most accurately described as:

A. a shared rejection of all metaphysics in favour of experimental psychology alone. B. a revolt against idealist system-building through three distinct uses of analysis C. a single doctrine that identifies common sense with logical atomism D. a defence of British Idealism through more exact grammatical distinctions

MCQ 2

Which attribution is exact?

A. Moore—verification; Russell—family resemblance; Wittgenstein—common-sense certainty as their defining methods B. Moore—defence of common sense; Russell—incomplete symbols; early Wittgenstein—saying/showing C. Moore—logical constructions; Russell—diaphanous consciousness; Wittgenstein—ordinary names D. Moore—negative facts; Russell—hinge propositions; Wittgenstein—proof by two hands

MCQ 3

Which chronology is correct?

A. Moore's 1903 refutation; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Russell's 1918 lectures; *Tractatus* 1921/22; Moore's 1925 defence and 1939 proof B. Russell's 1918 lectures; Moore's 1903 refutation; *Tractatus* 1921/22; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Moore's 1939 proof C. Moore's 1925 defence; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Moore's 1903 refutation; *Tractatus* 1921/22; Russell's 1918 lectures D. *Tractatus* 1921/22; Russell's 1905 descriptions; Moore's 1939 proof; Moore's 1903 refutation; Russell's 1918 lectures

MCQ 4

Moore's distinction between knowing and analysing permits him to claim that:

A. ordinary propositions remain uncertain until philosophers complete a final conceptual analysis of them B. a proposition may be known with certainty even when its correct analysis remains disputed C. correct analysis changes the truth-value of the proposition being analysed D. common-sense knowledge is merely shorthand for majority agreement

MCQ 5

The paradox of analysis arises because a correct analysis appears:

A. either empirically verified, or metaphysically meaningless B. either identical and uninformative, or informative and therefore not identical C. either a logically proper name, or an incomplete symbol D. either a tautology, or a contradiction in logical space

MCQ 6

Moore's truisms are best understood as:

- A. claims certified solely by widespread public assent and established philosophical convention over time
- B. analytic truths whose denial is formally self-contradictory in every possible case
- C. ordinary world-propositions claimed to be known more certainly than sceptical premises
- D. scientific hypotheses confirmed only by repeated observation and induction

MCQ 7

Moore's central reply to scepticism is a burden reversal because:

- A. he derives the external world from premises accepted by every radical sceptic
- B. he shows that dreaming is logically impossible whenever hands are visible
- C. he replaces perceptual knowledge with knowledge of private sense-data
- D. he argues that no sceptical premise is more certain than the truism it denies

MCQ 8

In Moore's hands proof, which list gives his three conditions for a rigorous proof?

- A. the premise is probable, the conclusion is useful, and the sceptic accepts both
- B. the premise is analytic, the inference is inductive, and the conclusion is certain
- C. the premise differs from the conclusion, is known, and entails the conclusion
- D. the premise is private, the gesture is public, and the result is verifiable

MCQ 9

What follows immediately from Moore's two-hand illustration?

- A. at least two material objects exist, so an external world exists
- B. all perceptual beliefs are infallible in every possible circumstance
- C. the radical sceptic accepts that Moore knows the premises
- D. realism has been derived without any appeal to ordinary knowledge

MCQ 10

The strongest standard objection to Moore's proof is that it:

- A. begs the question by asserting knowledge where the sceptic challenges entitlement
- B. uses a conclusion identical with its premise, making the proof formally circular throughout
- C. fails because a hand is not an object located in space at all
- D. depends upon Berkeley's claim that existence is perception

MCQ 11

A defensible verdict on Moore's proof is that it:

- A. is invalid because external objects cannot include parts of one's body
- B. refutes every possible sceptical hypothesis by formal contradiction
- C. proves the complete metaphysics of mind-independent material substance
- D. is valid if the premises are known but may not persuade a radical sceptic

MCQ 12

Moore's *Refutation of Idealism* directly targets:

- A. Berkeley's equation *esse est percipi*
- B. Hegel's claim that the rational is actual
- C. Russell's theory of negative facts
- D. Wittgenstein's distinction between saying and showing

MCQ 13

In Moore's blue/green example, what remains common and what varies?

- A. the object remains common while consciousness varies with each colour
- B. both consciousness and object remain numerically identical
- C. consciousness remains common while blue and green are distinct objects
- D. neither act nor object can be distinguished within sensation

MCQ 14

Calling consciousness 'diaphanous' means that:

- A. awareness is transparent and attention passes through it to the object
- B. awareness is a coloured mental item located beside the presented sensible quality
- C. consciousness is identical with every object that it presents
- D. introspection supplies a complete description of awareness itself

MCQ 15

What is the exact force of Moore's act/object distinction?

- A. it proves that every object continues to exist when wholly unperceived
- B. it demonstrates that consciousness is a physical relation among material objects in every possible case
- C. it establishes that Hegelian Absolute Idealism is internally contradictory
- D. it shows awareness and object are non-identical, blocking a simple definition of being as perceived

MCQ 16

Russell calls his atoms logical rather than physical because they are:

A. microscopic particles discovered by the final science of matter B. the last residues reached through analysis of propositional structure C. private images whose size cannot be measured physically D. objects defined by the verification principle of the Vienna Circle

MCQ 17

An atomic fact in Russell's 1918 account is:

A. a sentence made true solely by its grammatical construction and logical syntax B. a physical object containing no smaller material components C. a particular exemplifying a quality or particulars standing in a relation D. a logical connective joining two independent propositions

MCQ 18

In Russell's atomism, the relation between atomic and molecular propositions is that:

A. atomic propositions are abbreviations for molecular propositions B. both kinds are logically proper names of complex objects C. molecular propositions alone correspond directly to atomic facts D. molecular propositions are truth-functions of atomic propositions

MCQ 19

Russell's isomorphism thesis claims that a true atomic proposition:

A. shares logical structure with its fact: names and arrangement correspond B. resembles its fact visually in the manner of a photograph C. is analytically true regardless of which possible state of affairs obtains in reality D. contains the fact itself as one of its linguistic constituents

MCQ 20

Why did Russell accept negative facts, despite their ontological cost?

A. to treat negation as a physical object in the world B. to supply truth-makers for true negative propositions C. to copy the *Tractatus* account of logical constants D. to eliminate qualities and relations from atomic facts

MCQ 21

A definite description is an incomplete symbol because it:

A. has a hidden referent that cannot be known by acquaintance B. contributes only in a complete proposition and disappears on analysis C. is an ordinary name whose reference is fixed by causal history D. forms a meaningless fragment whenever its object does not exist

MCQ 22

Russell's analysis of 'The F is G' contains:

A. direct acquaintance, remembered presentations and introspected mental events B. Fregean sense and reference together with Strawson's presupposition account C. simples, possible combinations and their logical coordinates D. an existence claim, a uniqueness condition and attribution of G

MCQ 23

On Russell's analysis, 'The present King of France is bald' is:

A. false because the required existence conjunct has no satisfier in the world B. meaningless because its grammatical subject lacks a bearer C. neither true nor false because Russell treats existence as presupposed in ordinary use D. true on the condition that baldness is understood negatively

MCQ 24

The sentence 'The golden mountain is very high' commits Russell to:

A. one subsisting but non-existent golden mountain B. no golden mountain, because the analysed existence clause is false C. a logically proper name whose bearer is available in sensation D. a truth-value gap generated by failed presupposition on Russell's view

MCQ 25

The primary/secondary occurrence distinction is needed chiefly to handle:

A. the scope of descriptions relative to negation B. the difference between physical and logical atoms C. the contrast between awareness and its object D. the hierarchy between object-language and metalanguage

MCQ 26

Strawson's central challenge to Russell is that ordinary use of an empty description:

A. asserts existence as part of a false conjunction in every ordinary conversational use B. presupposes existence, so failed presupposition may block truth-value C. requires a Meinongian object to preserve meaningfulness D. becomes a tautology once logical form is displayed in the completed analysis

MCQ 27

How does description theory support, but not entail, logical atomism?

A. it proves that all ultimate atoms must be private sense-data and entirely excludes universals from the final ontology B. it removes apparent constituents and leaves candidates for simples without proving the final inventory C. it converts each molecular proposition into a corresponding physical atom after analysis D. it establishes logical independence merely from the contextual meaning of description phrases

MCQ 28

Russell's Principle of Acquaintance states that:

A. all knowledge concerns objects reached only by description B. ordinary proper names guarantee direct presentation of their bearers C. every understood proposition is composed of constituents with which we are acquainted D. material objects are immediately given as complete wholes

MCQ 29

In Russell's Bismarck example, a person who never met Bismarck knows him:

A. by description, such as the first Chancellor of the German Empire B. by direct acquaintance with Bismarck's own sense-data C. through a logically proper demonstrative fixed in present experience D. not at all, because indirect knowledge is impossible

MCQ 30

For Russell, ordinary proper names such as 'Bismarck' are generally:

A. logically proper names whose bearers are guaranteed by syntax B. incomplete symbols whose occurrence makes every containing sentence meaningless as a whole C. disguised descriptions, unlike demonstratives tied to present acquaintance D. names of universals rather than of particular persons at all

MCQ 31

The main pressure on Russell's acquaintance base is that it:

A. contains too many publicly accessible material objects to serve as a minimal logical foundation B. makes every ordinary name a rigid designator through immediate presentation of its bearer C. becomes too thin and near-solipsistic when restricted to present sense-data D. eliminates the distinction between particulars and universals

MCQ 32

Russell's supreme maxim recommends that philosophers:

A. replace every proposition with a verification report from natural science B. substitute constructions from known entities for inferences to unknown entities where possible C. infer hidden material substances whenever sense-data appear orderly D. treat all constructions as useful fictions lacking truth conditions

MCQ 33

A Russellian material object as a logical construction is best described as:

A. a hidden substance inferred behind all possible appearances B. a single physical atom that causes every private sensation C. an orderly system of actual and possible sense-data D. a metaphysical object shown but incapable of being said

MCQ 34

The best qualified assessment of logical constructions is that they:

A. eliminate every inference and establish a complete public ontology without residual assumptions B. are identical with Wittgenstein's unspecified simple objects C. depend on Strawson's presupposition theory of ordinary reference D. secure economy but face private-data, other-minds and residual-inference problems

MCQ 35

The opening ontological claim of the *Tractatus* is that:

A. facts collectively constitute the world rather than a mere inventory of things B. the world consists exclusively of private sense-data immediately presented to a solitary knower C. the world is whatever common sense certifies with certainty D. the world is a hierarchy of object-languages and metalanguages

MCQ 36

In the *Tractatus*, a state of affairs is:

A. a complete list of all things regardless of combination B. a mental image produced by a perceiving subject C. a molecular proposition built from logical constants D. a combination of objects within logical space

MCQ 37

According to picture theory, an elementary proposition represents because:

A. its words visually resemble the objects named in every language B. its names and their arrangement map objects and their possible arrangement C. it has been empirically verified by a competent observer D. its grammatical subject denotes an independently existing substance

MCQ 38

Pictorial form differs from logical form because:

A. logical form varies with colour or spatial medium, while pictorial form never varies B. pictorial form is grammatical syntax, while logical form is a private mental image C. pictorial form may vary with a representational medium, while logical form is common to every picture and reality D. logical form is one more empirical feature that a proposition can state about itself

MCQ 39

Bipolarity requires a genuine factual proposition to be:

A. true in every possible state of affairs B. capable of truth and capable of falsity C. false in every possible state of affairs D. meaningful only after empirical confirmation

MCQ 40

The logical independence of elementary propositions is pressured by:

A. the colour-exclusion case, where one colour attribution rules out another B. Moore's two-hand proof, because one premise entails an external-world conclusion C. Strawson's claim that descriptions carry presuppositions D. Russell's distinction between acquaintance and description

MCQ 41

For early Wittgenstein, molecular propositions are generated from elementary propositions by:

A. inductive generalisation from repeatedly observed atomic objects B. the synthesis of a grammatical subject with a metaphysical substance C. a hierarchy in which every proposition moves to a higher language D. truth-functional operations expressed in the general form of proposition

MCQ 42

Let $N(\xi)$ be generalised joint negation over any finite set of propositions: it denies every member of ξ . Thus $N(p, q) = \neg p \wedge \neg q$ and $\neg p = N(p)$. Which formula expresses $p \vee q$?

A. $N(p, q)$ B. $N(N(p), N(q))$ C. $N(N(p, q))$ D. $N(N(N(p, q)))$

MCQ 43

A tautology in the *Tractatus* is classified as:

A. *sinnlos*: well-formed but without factual content B. *unsinnig*: an ill-formed metaphysical pseudo-proposition C. a false elementary proposition excluded by reality D. an ethical truth that can only be shown

MCQ 44

Which contrast is exact?

A. tautology is contingently true whereas contradiction is contingently false in actual logical space B. tautology is shown, while contradiction is an empirical proposition C. both are unsinnig because neither can be verified by observation D. tautology and contradiction delimit logical space without depicting a contingent fact

MCQ 45

The distinction between *sinnlos* and *unsinnig* is best stated as:

A. the former is false language, the latter true but unverifiable language B. the former belongs to Moore, the latter belongs to Russell C. the former is empty yet well-formed logic, the latter violates the conditions of sense D. the former can be pictured, the latter is a molecular truth-function

MCQ 46

In the saying/showing distinction, propositions can say:

A. the logical form shared by language and reality B. the absolute value that makes ethical action good C. contingent states of affairs capable of truth or falsity D. the metaphysical subject as an object located within the empirical world

MCQ 47

What belongs on the 'shown, not said' side for early Wittgenstein?

A. scientific hypotheses awaiting empirical confirmation B. ordinary descriptions whose apparent subject currently lacks a bearer C. Moorean truisms and Russellian sense-data treated as factual claims D. representational form together with value, beauty and the mystical

MCQ 48

The ladder metaphor at *Tractatus* 6.54 means that:

A. higher metalanguages permanently preserve every sentence of the book as fact B. the propositions become scientific hypotheses after empirical confirmation C. logical form can finally be stated from outside all possible representation D. the book's elucidations are recognised as nonsense and discarded after use

MCQ 49

The standard and resolute readings disagree chiefly over whether:

- A. elementary propositions can be true as well as false
- B. Russell's descriptions contain existence and uniqueness
- C. the *Tractatus* gestures at ineffable truths or offers only therapeutic nonsense
- D. Moore's hands satisfy three proof conditions in the final analysis

MCQ 50

Who proposes the hierarchy of languages discussed in the 2026 question?

- A. early Wittgenstein in proposition 7
- B. Tarski in Wittgenstein's 1918 notebooks
- C. the Vienna Circle in Moore's 1939 proof
- D. Russell in his 1922 Introduction to the *Tractatus*

MCQ 51

A hierarchy of languages most clearly succeeds in:

- A. stating the logical form common to representation from a final standpoint
- B. giving a metalanguage for syntax or truth of a specified object-language
- C. making ethics and the mystical factual at a higher linguistic level
- D. eliminating the form of every metalanguage in a finite number of steps

MCQ 52

Why does the hierarchy fail as a complete answer to Wittgenstein?

- A. the hierarchy contains only one language and therefore cannot distinguish levels
- B. Wittgenstein denies that propositions possess any logical structure
- C. Russell requires every higher language to be empirically verified
- D. each metalanguage has its own unstated form, so the limit is displaced upward

MCQ 53

What is the proper use of Tarski in the 2026 hierarchy answer?

- A. as proof that Wittgenstein himself accepted Russell's hierarchy in 1921
- B. as the source of the *Tractatus* distinction between saying and showing
- C. as a Logical Positivist verification test for Moore's common-sense claims
- D. as later evidence that richer metalanguages solve formal truth-definition problems

MCQ 54

How should the later Wittgenstein be used in the hierarchy answer?

A. as a bounded comparison: he abandons the demand for one logical form rather than ascending a hierarchy B. as evidence that the early picture theory already contained the later doctrine of language-games in developed form C. as the primary owner of the 2026 hierarchy question because his mature work concerns language D. as confirmation that the private-language argument supplies a final unrestricted metalanguage

MCQ 55

Which ownership statement is correct for adjacent material?

A. verificationism is Logical Positivism-owned, while the 2026 hierarchy issue is primarily owned here B. private-language arguments are early-Wittgenstein doctrines because both projects concern language and meaning C. the 2018 Berkeley comparison is one of this topic's sixteen direct PYQs D. Tarski's truth theory is a doctrine stated by Moore in defence of common sense

MCQ 56

Which accounting of directly owned PYQs is accurate?

A. sixteen parts from 2018–2025 plus two further cross-links in 2026 B. fourteen parts through 2026 because both new questions belong elsewhere C. fourteen parts from 2018–2025 plus two 2026 additions, totalling sixteen D. eighteen parts after counting Berkeley, private language and verificationism